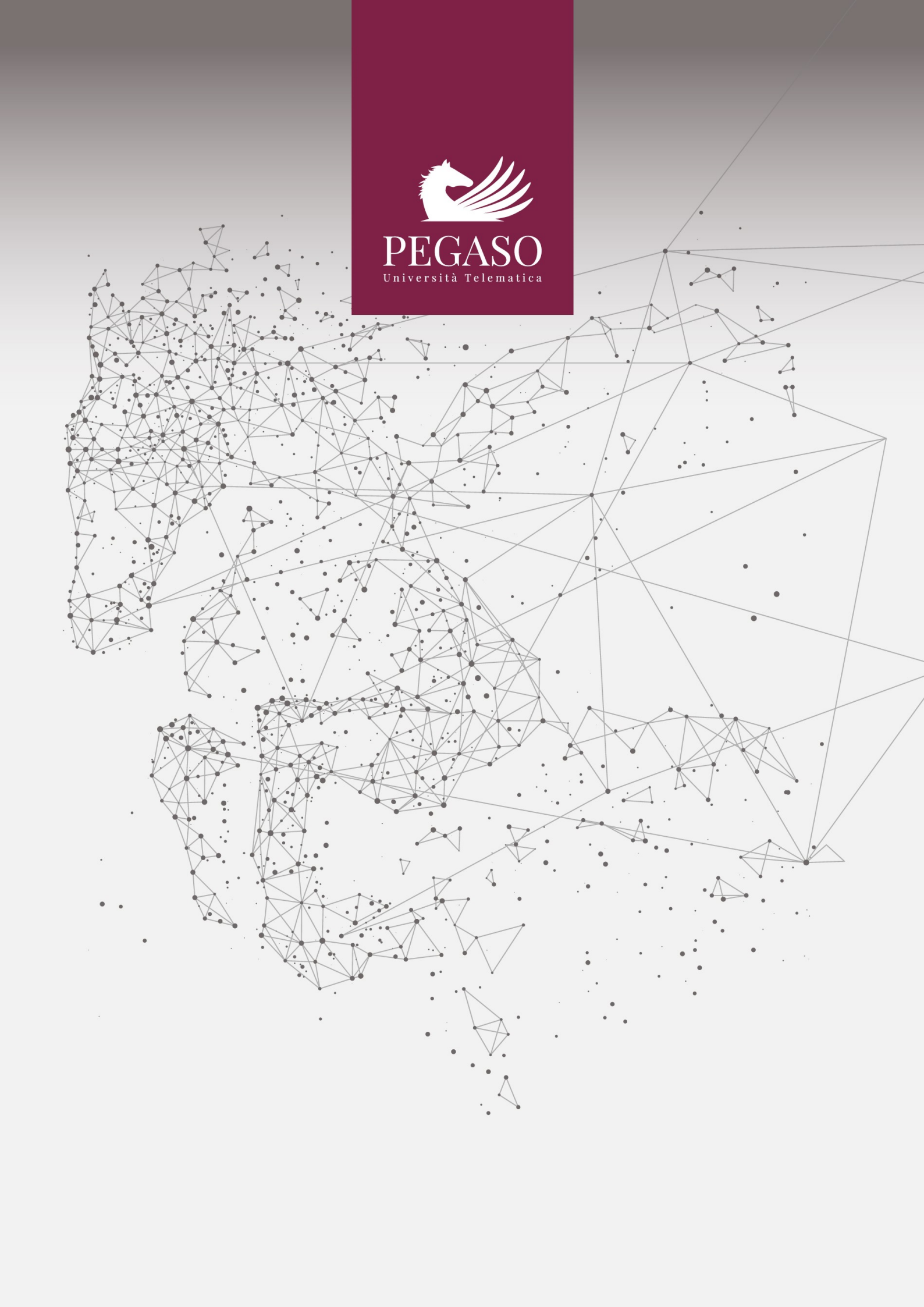

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

Indice

1. INTRODUCTION TO THE VERB HAVE 3
2. FUNCTIONS OF HAVE 7
3. USEFUL EXPRESSIONS WITH HAVE 10
BIBLIOGRAFIA 13

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

1. Introduction to the verb have

The verb Have has an important role in the English language. It is used in several different ways.

1. Have is used as a **main verb**:

a. to talk about **possession, relationships and some states**

They have three cars.

Have you got any brothers or sisters?

Do you often have headaches?

b. to talk about actions and experiences

I'm going to have a shower.

We had a dinner party next Sunday.

c. to talk about obligation / necessity (similar to the modal must); have + to + infinitive

I had to finish that project in a hurry.

d. to talk about causing or experiencing actions and events, have is used as a causative; have + object + present participle (doing) / past participle (done)

He had us all laughing.

I must have my shoes repaired.

We had our car stolen last week.

2. Have is also an important **auxiliary verb** used in making the perfect tense forms.

I remembered her from the meeting, but I had not remembered her name.

We had been waiting for the bus for nearly an hour when it finally arrived.

Forms of Have as a main verb:

In the Present and Past Simple:

Have has two forms in the present:

I / You / We / They	**have**
She / He / It	**has**

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

Have has only one form in the past:

had

In questions: Have uses the verb Do as an auxiliary to form the question.

Do / Does / Did + subject + have…?

Examples:

Do you have a pencil I can borrow? Did she call you this morning?

In negative phrases: Have uses Do + not to form the negative form.

Do / Does / Did + not + have…

Examples:

I didn't have a good time.

She doesn't have a job at the moment.

The present simple of the verb Have (**have | has**) is often contracted with a subject. You join the conjugated verb to the subject and replace the first two letters of the verb with an apostrophe.

not contracted	words joined	delete first two letters	**contracted**
I have	Ihave	I~~ha~~ve	I've
They have	Theyhave	They~~ha~~ve	They've

In American English, **has** is not normally contracted with a subject when it is the main verb in a sentence.

uncontracted (common)	**contracted** (not common)
I have a red bike.	I've a red bike.
We have good jobs.	We've good jobs.

Instead, American English users prefer using the present perfect with **got** (past participle of the verb GET).

PEGASO Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

uncontracted		**contracted**		**American English**
I have a blue car.		I've a blue car.		I've got a blue car.
We have good news.		We've good news.		We've got good news.

Has can never be contracted with its subject (**he**, **she**, or **it**) when it is the main verb in the sentence and is in the present tense.

uncontracted	≠	**incorrect**
He has a boat.		~~He's a boat~~.
She has a cat.		~~She's a cat~~.

Note false contractions that look the same as contractions made with BE and change the meaning:

He+is	=	He's
She+is		She's
It+is		It's

However, these contractions are possible when HAVE is the auxiliary verb in the sentence.

uncontracted	=	**contracted**
He has gone.		He's gone.
It has hailed.		It's hailed.

How we can identify these contractions are formed with **has** is by noting that they are followed by past participles (**gone** | **hailed**).

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

In negative statements, the auxiliary verb HAVE is often contracted with the adverb of negation **not**. You join **not** to the conjugation and replace the **o** with an apostrophe.

uncontracted	words joined	delete the **o**	**contracted**
have not	havenot	haven~~o~~t	haven't
has not	hasnot	hasn~~o~~t	hasn't

Here are examples of both forms of contraction: (subject + HAVE) and (HAVE + not).

uncontracted	**less common**	**more common**
I have not left.	I've not left.	I haven't left.
You have not smiled.	You've not smiled.	You haven't smiled.
He has not begun.	He's not begun.	He hasn't begun.
It has not hailed.	It's not hailed.	It hasn't hailed.
We have not done it.	We've not done it.	We haven't done it.
They have not started.	They've not started.	They haven't started.

There is **no** difference in meaning between these two forms of contraction, but the contractions with **not** are more common.

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

2. Functions of HAVE

Have as a main verb has a few meanings:

1. Have is used to talk about **possession** as well as relationships, illness, characteristics of people and things etc.

I think our apartment has mice.

My grandfather had an unpleasant character.

She didn't have any siblings.

In this form, Have is considered a state verb (non-active) and therefore is not used in the continuous form.

She has had her car for 4 years. (She has been having her car for 4 years.)

Note: Have + got is an alternative to Have for possession etc. and means exactly the same thing. Have + got is considered a present tense form (not used to refer to past possession etc.). It is more natural in spoken English but generally less common in American English. Do is not used in questions and negatives with Have + got. Instead simple inversion of subject and Have is used to make questions and negative forms.

Have you got a headache?

This apartment hasn't got a big bathroom.

In short answers or question tags we repeat Have and not got.

A: Have you got a daughter? B: No, I haven't.

Susan's got a tight deadline, hasn't she?

2. Have is used for actions and experiences.

Let's have a drink.

I'm going to have a shower now.

They had a good time at the party.

(In these contexts, Have can mean eat, drink, enjoy,

experience etc. The exact meaning depends on the noun that follows.)

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

3. Have is used to indicate causing or experiencing actions and events:

Have + someone + infinitive (cause action in another person)

I'm ready to see the director. Have her come in, please.

Have + object + past participle (cause something to be done by another person)

The manager had the office painted while we were on holiday.

I should have my hair cut soon.

Have + object + **gerund** (cause something to be happening now by another person)

Alternatively, **Have** + object + **past participle / gerund** can indicate "experience" something without willingly causing it, sometimes to indicate a "negative" experience.

He had a very strange thing happen to him on his way to work yesterday.

We had someone break into our house last summer while we were away.

It's lovely to have people using the park as it should.

She had her bag stolen from her desk.

4. Have is used for **obligation / necessity**.

Have + to + **infinitive**

Do you have to travel a lot for work?

Will you have to return early from your holiday?

Did she have to retake the exam?

Again, similarly to the expression of possession etc., **Have** + **got** + **infinitive** is an alternative to Have in spoken English to express the same sense of obligation or necessity but only for the present or future.

Sorry, I've got to go now.

You have got to do your homework on time.

We have got to arrive before 10:00 tomorrow morning.

As an auxiliary verb, Have is used in the Perfect Tenses

The forms are: **have + past participle**

have + been + gerund (continuous)

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

Present Perfect:

They have opened a new market in the center.

She hasn't returned my call.

Has he lived here long?

Present Perfect Continuous:

They have been working for this company since last January.

Her daughter has not been living with her.

Have they been doing a lot of renovations on that old building?

Past Perfect:

He had forgotten his phone so he couldn't make reach his wife.

They hadn't read the memo.

Had the managers decided to start the meeting before you were ready?

Past Perfect Continuous:

She had been waiting for the bus for nearly an hour when it finally arrived.

We hadn't been eating at the time.

Future Perfect:

We will have bought a house by this time next year.

They will have arrived by the time we leave.

Will she have finished the painting by the time you need it for the show.

Future Perfect Continuous:

If things continue to go well, the company will be acquiring more assets in March.

We won't be living here anymore when he comes for a visit.

Will you be having lunch when I call you tomorrow at 12:00?

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

3. Useful Expressions with HAVE

For Have when used for **actions and experiences**:

have breakfast / lunch / supper / dinner

have tea / coffee / a drink

have a bath / a wash / a shave / a shower

have a rest / a lie-down / a sleep / a dream

have a good time / a bad day / a nice evening / a day off / a holiday

have a talk / a chat / a word with somebody / a conversation

have a disagreement / a row / a fight

have a swim / a walk / a ride / a dance / a game of tennis etc.

have a try / have a go/ have a look

have a baby (= give birth)

have difficulty or trouble + (verb)ing

have an accident / have an operation / have a nervous breakdown

have a think

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

Exercises

Read the situations and write sentences as shown in the example.

1. Jack is driving a car, but he's very nervous and not sure what to do.

Ex.

You ask: Have you driven a car before?

He says: No, this is the first time l've driven a car.

2. Ben is playing tennis. He's not good at it and he doesn't know the rules.

You ask: Have ....

He says: No, this is the first.

3. Sue is riding a horse. She doesn't look very confident or comfortable.

You ask:

She says:

4. Maria is in London. She has just arrived and it's very new for her.

You ask:

She says:

Complete the sentences (1, 2 or 3 words) with the present perfect.

5. Mark and Liz are married. They ... married for five years.

6. David …… watching TV since 5 o'clock.

7. Martin is at work. He …… at work since 8:30pm.

8. Have you just arrived in London? No, I've …… since yesterday.

9. I've ….. Helen since we were at school.

10. My brother lives in Los Angeles. Really, how long ……there?

11. George …… the same job for five years.

12. Some friends of ours are staying with us at the moment. They …… here for three days

Translate the indicated present perfect sentences in this biographical description of Noam Chomsky into Italian.

Noam Chomsky was born in the United States on December 7, 1928, in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania. (13.)He is an American theoretical linguist, whose work, which started in the 1950s, has revolutionized the field of linguistics by treating language as a uniquely human, biologically based cognitive capacity. (14.)

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

Through his contributions to linguistics and related fields, including cognitive psychology, and the philosophies of mind and language, Chomsky has helped to initiate and sustain what has come to be known as the "cognitive revolution." (15.) Chomsky has also gained a worldwide following as a political dissident for his analysis of the pernicious influence of economic elites on US domestic politics, foreign policy, and intellectual culture.

Exercise answer key

1. No, this is the first time I've driven a car.
2. Have you played tennis before?
3. Have you ridden a horse before? No this is the first time.
4. Have you been in London before? No, this is the first time.
5. They have been married for five years.
6. David has been watching TV since 5 o'clock.
7. He has been at work since 8:30pm.
8. No, I've been here since yesterday.
9. I've known Helen since we were at school.
10. Really, how long has he lived there?
11. George has had the same job for five years.
12. They have been here for three days.
13. È un linguista teorico americano, il cui lavoro, iniziato negli anni Cinquanta, ha rivoluzionato il campo della linguistica poiché concepisce il linguaggio come una capacità cognitiva esclusivamente umana basata sulla biologia.
14. Attraverso i suoi contributi alla linguistica e ai suoi settori correlati, tra cui la psicologia cognitiva e le filosofie della mente e del linguaggio, Chomsky ha contribuito ad avviare e promuovere quella che è diventata nota come la "rivoluzione cognitiva".
15. Chomsky ha anche ottenuto un seguito mondiale come dissidente politico per la sua analisi sull'influenza negativa delle élite economiche sulla politica interna, la politica estera e la cultura intellettuale degli Stati Uniti.

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).

Bibliografia

- R. Murphy, Essential Grammar in Use Third Edition, Cambridge, Cambridge University Press, 2007
- M. Swan, Practical English Usage New Third Edition, Oxford, Oxford University Press, 2005
- C. Latham-Koening, C. Oxenden, K. Chomacki, English File Upper-Intermediate Fourth Edition, Oxford, Oxford University Press, 2020

PEGASO
Università Telematica

Attenzione! Questo materiale didattico è per uso personale dello studente ed è coperto da copyright. Ne è severamente vietata la riproduzione o il riutilizzo anche parziale, ai sensi e per gli effetti della legge sul diritto d'autore (L. 22.04.1941/n. 633).